Redesign Exploration for **the Seattle Jazz Fellowship**

Jordan Cheung | Prof. Linda Wagner | TA Anoolia Gakhokidze
HCDE 308: Visual Communication in HCDE | Autumn 2025

Table of Contents

Introduction - 3
Description, value proposition, audience, brand attributes.

Context - 4
Brand ecosystem, existing materials, competitive landscape.

Design Inspiration and Alignment - 6
Images, colors.

Typography - 7
Typeface, hierarchy.

Identity - 8
Wordmark and logo.

Analog Redesign: Sandwich Board - 9
Cohesion, information access.

Digital Redesign: Website - 10
Information architecture, home, volunteer.

Appendix - 15
AI usage, redesign iterations, preliminary sketches, image sources.

Introduction

This brief outlines proposed redesign directions for the Seattle Jazz Fellowship, an IRS-recognized 501(c)3 registered not-for-profit corporation.

Value proposition

The Seattle Jazz Fellowship strives to foster a dynamic and inclusive jazz community for both performers and listeners.

They host jazz shows in Pioneer Square, partner with jazz and community organizations, offer jazz mentorship, and promote local artists.

Audience

The Seattle Jazz Fellowship seeks to:

- Attract new and longtime **jazz listeners**.
- Invest in **local artists** by providing a space for them to perform and offering mentorship.
- Connect artists to **mentors**.
- Work with **jazz and community organizations**.
- Motivate **sponsors** and **donors** to support their cause.

Brand attributes

The Seattle Jazz Fellowship's website conveys the following brand attributes and characteristics:

- Strong commitment to community building and serious musicianship.
- Professional, almost academic tone.
- Sleek, simplistic, tasteful.

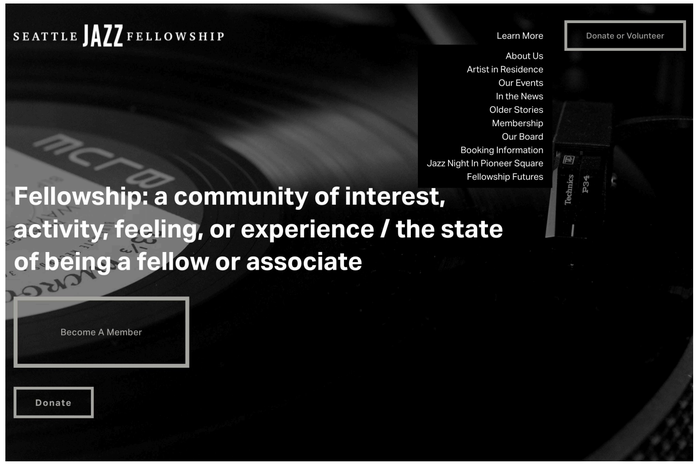
Context

Brand ecosystem

The Seattle Jazz Fellowship is primarily a standalone corporation with no connected products or brands. However, the Fellowship actively collaborates with local artists, some of whom also serve on its board.

Instead of incorporating elements from each artist's personal brand, the redesign mirrors common themes displayed on their websites (such as simplicity and professional artistry).

Website home page



Event photo



Logo



Advertisement card



Context

Competitive landscape

In Seattle, there are numerous musical organizations that the Seattle Jazz Fellowship could work with, including:

The **Seattle Symphony**, which is a major institution in the Seattle Arts scene. It holds large-scale productions of formal and informal concert experiences with renowned artists, making music appealing to broad audiences, as The Seattle Jazz Fellowship does.

Seattle Music Teachers Association (SMTA), which is focused on music education, supporting teachers and students in developing technical and artistic music skills (like The Seattle Jazz Fellowship). SMTA is more focused on pedagogy rather than performance, but it shares The Seattle Jazz Fellowship's values in nurturing musical growth and mentorship.

Seattle Music Partners (SMP), which is also a local nonprofit. They combine music education with social impact, providing free after-school lessons and mentoring to underserved youth. SMP aligns closely with The Seattle Jazz Fellowship's community-based mission and dedication to outreach and education.

Design Inspiration and Alignment



Image 1 (above) is a photograph of the Seattle Jazz Fellowship's performance setup. The moody, dark, artistic ambience is reflected in the brand's attributes and should be carried forward into new materials.

Images 2 and 3 (below) are bold, punchy designs that remain clean and minimal (qualities that align with the current brand). Both posters feel very intentional and music-focused, conveying a sense of seriousness and clarity.





Images 4, 5, and 6 (above) of jazz club settings further embody the Seattle Jazz Fellowship's air of sophistication and simplicity. The distinct shapes made by the lighting fixtures add flourish and focus, making each image more visually interesting and alluring.

D12C2F

000000

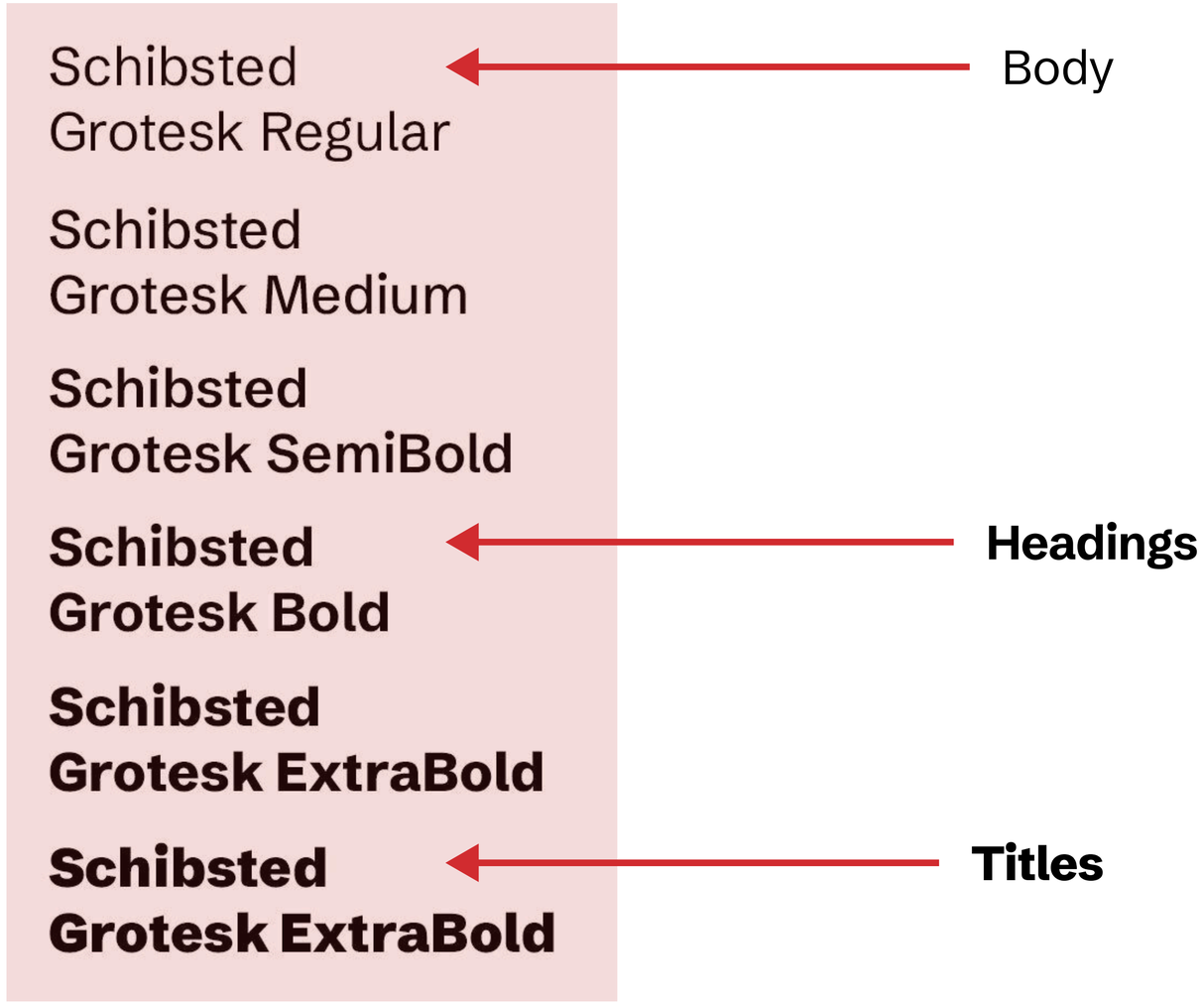
FFFFFF

The monochromatic color palette (left) reflects the tones of the visual references, conveying power and simplicity with black, white, and bold red.

Typography

Schibsted Grotesk strikes the balance between professionalism, simplicity, and personality. The typeface feels bold without being overpowering, which matches the energy of jazz while still supporting a clean, modern visual system. It has a contemporary look while remaining accessible and legible.

The redesign relies on only one typeface, and Schibsted Grotesk's wide range of weights and styles makes it especially effective. The variations allow for the establishment of clear typographic hierarchy using just one font.



Identity

Wordmark and logo

This logo design draws inspiration from the metalwork on the iconic Pioneer Square pergola, paying tribute to Seattle Jazz Fellowship's roots in the district.

It also incorporates a bass clef/f-hole shape. Combined, the metalwork and musical symbol resemble the headstock and tuning pegs of a string instrument.

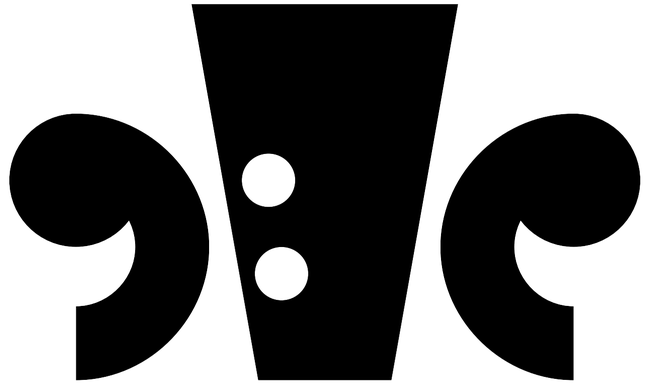
The blocky, abstract shape maintains a modern, bold feel, aligning with the feel of the typography.













Seattle Jazz Fellowship

Seattle Jazz Fellowship

Analog Redesign: Sandwich Board



The Seattle Jazz Fellowship posts this sandwich board outside of their venue when doors open for an event. It says “live jazz” and “Seattle Jazz Fellowship,” and it points onlookers in the direction of the aforementioned jazz. Both sides of the board are the same.

The existing design is very simplistic. It easily catches attention and communicates very directly.

It could be more effective with:

1. Brand font and color usage.
2. Visually interesting components that make it pop.
3. The logo icon to make the brand more recognizable.



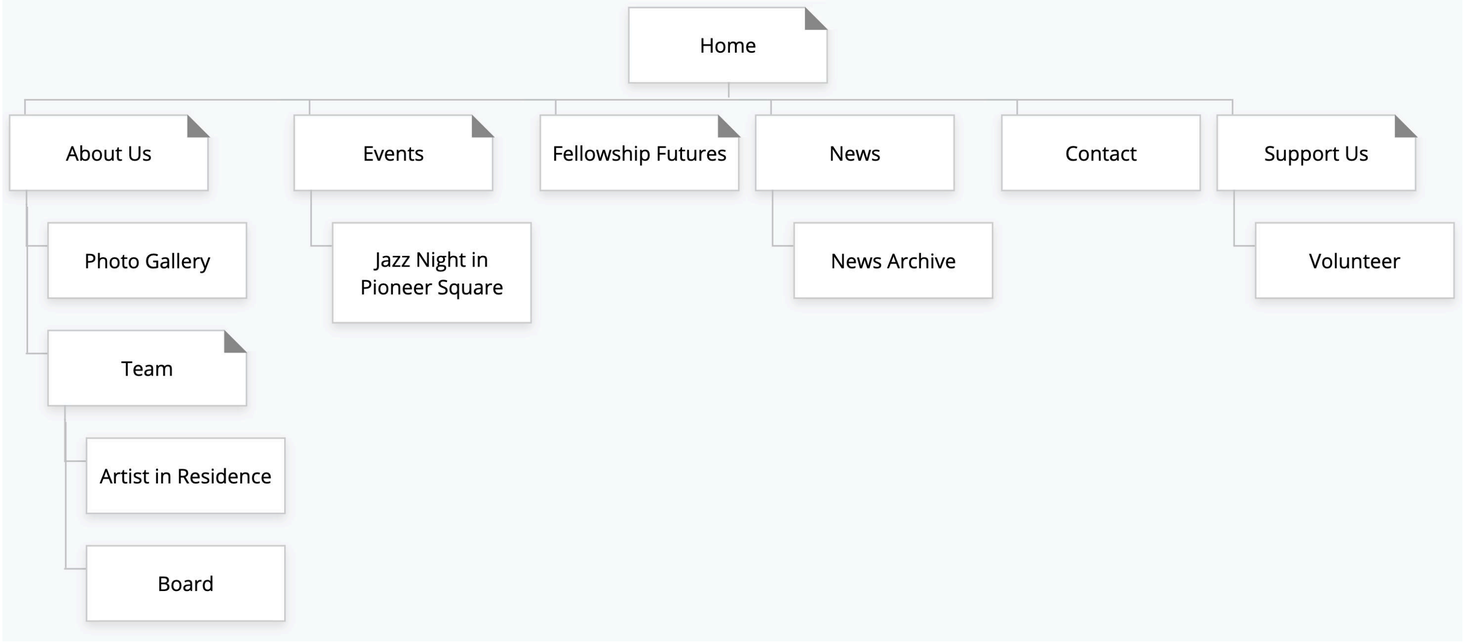


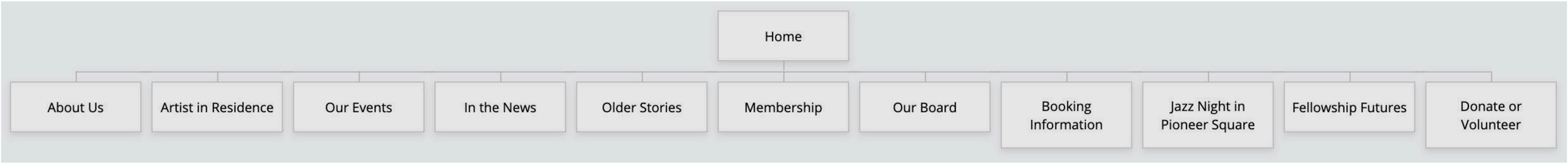
Digital Redesign: Website

Information Hierarchy

The existing information hierarchy of the Seattle Jazz Fellowship website (bottom, gray) uses a very linear structure. It lacks subpages, which yields a dense, uncategorized navigation bar that can increase cognitive load and navigation effort.

The information hierarchy could be improved with subpages that group related content (below). This creates a clearer structure, reduces the amount of information presented at once, and helps visitors locate what they need with less effort.





Digital Redesign: Website

Home page (before)

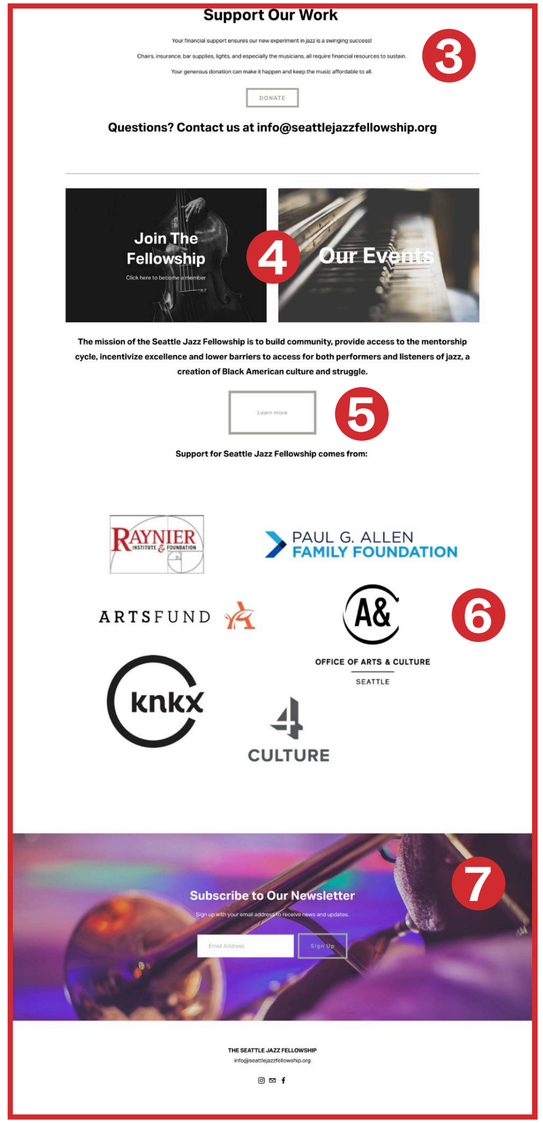
From top to bottom, the current home page shows visitors:

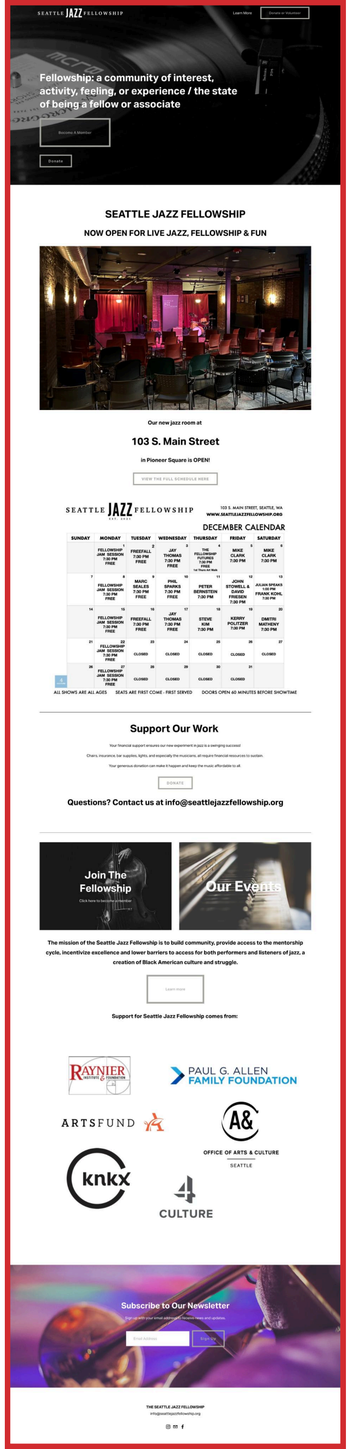
1. The purpose of the Seattle Jazz Fellowship and how to join and support it.
2. The venue and event information.
3. How to support the fellowship. (Redundant)
4. How to join the fellowship and access event information. (Redundant)
5. Further information about the Seattle Jazz Fellowship.
6. Sponsor information.
7. Newsletter information.

The key areas for improvement are:

- Reduce informational redundancy.
- Chunk information to make the flow of topics more balanced and distinct.
- Make calls to action (CTAs) more prominent.





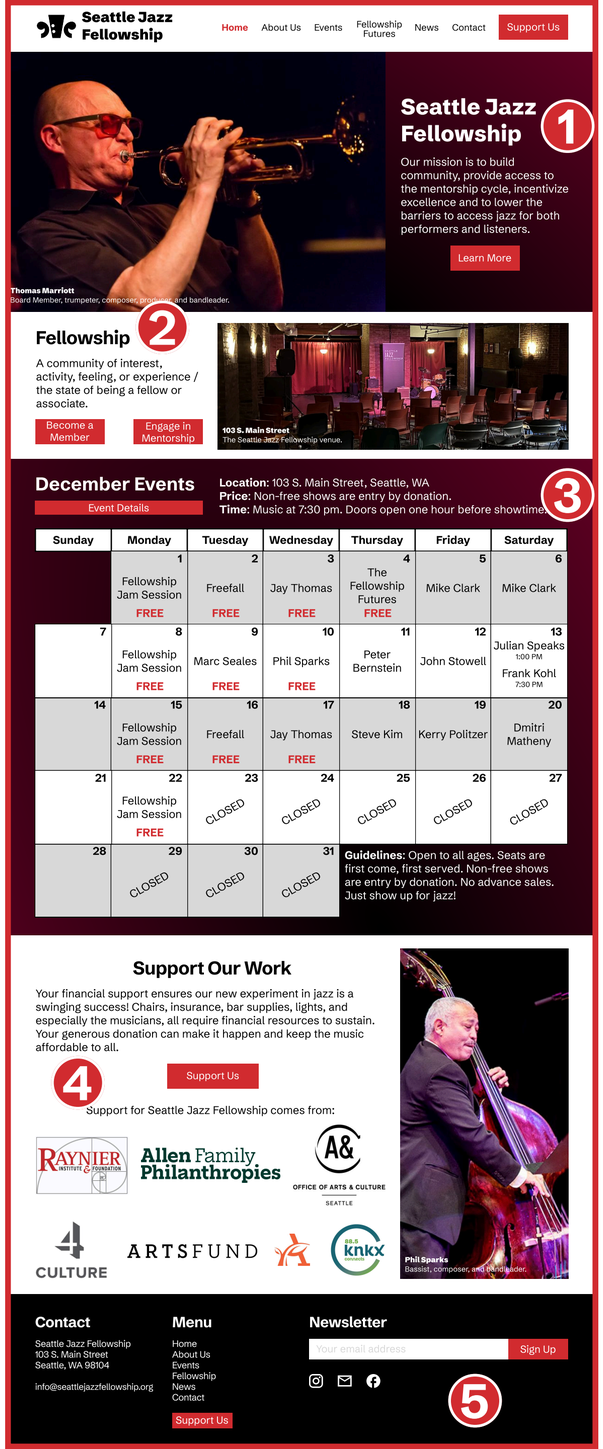


Digital Redesign: Website

Home page (after)

From top to bottom, the redesigned home page shows visitors:

1. Information about the Seattle Jazz Fellowship.
2. The purpose of the Seattle Jazz Fellowship and how to join it.
3. The venue and event information.
4. How to support the fellowship and sponsor information.
5. Newsletter information in the footer.



The restructured homepage reduces informational redundancy by removing overlap between topics.

Each topic now has its own distinct section, effectively chunking content to improve flow and clarity. Increased type weight and size establish strong typographical hierarchy.

CTAs are also more prominent, with the warm red styling helping them come forward from the page.

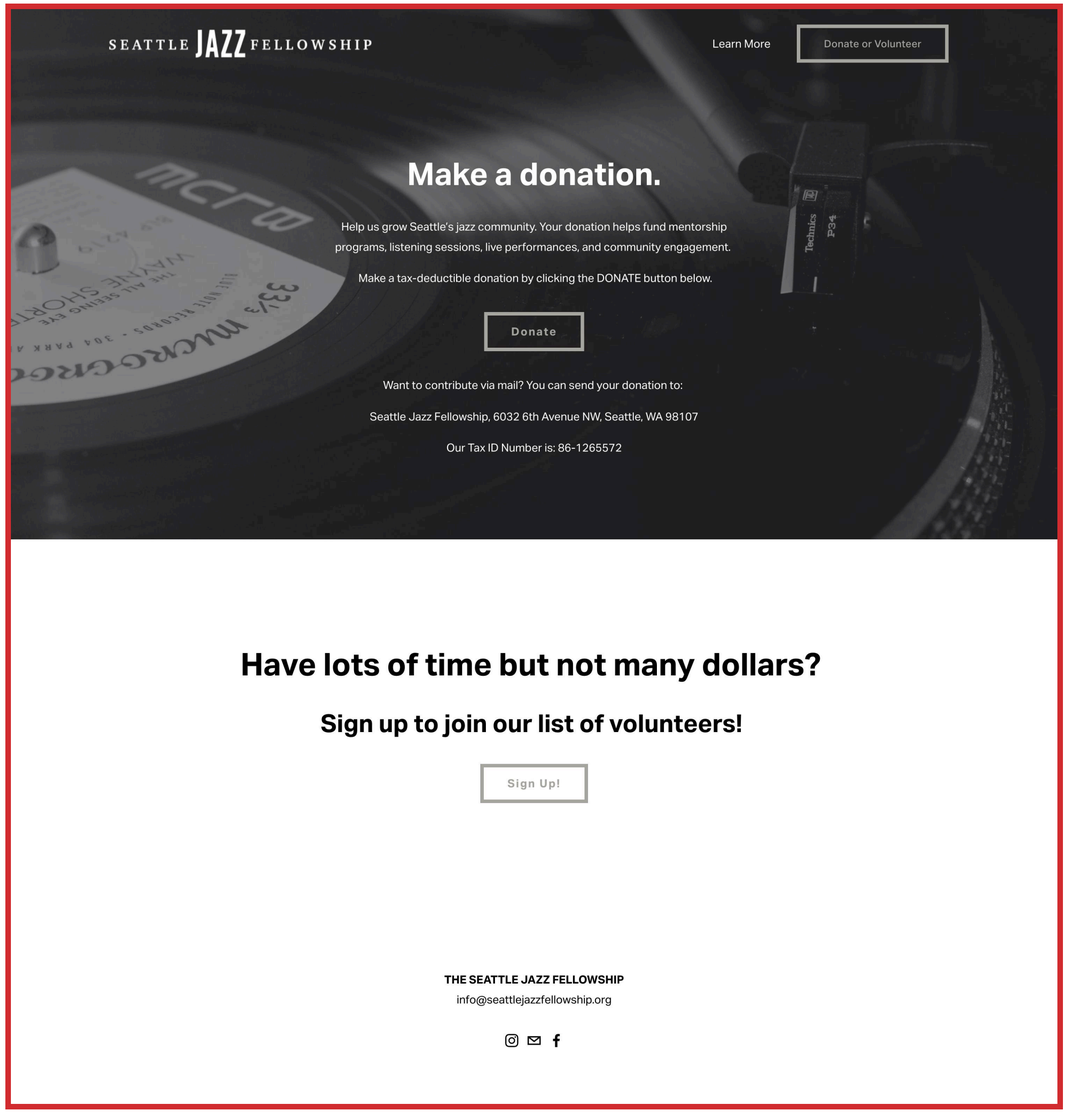
Digital Redesign: Website

Donate or Volunteer (before)

Currently, the Seattle Jazz Fellowship website combines their donation and volunteer information to form a “Donate or Volunteer” page.

The key areas for improvement are:

- Make the signup process feel less intimidating by clearly explaining what volunteering involves.
- Highlight the volunteer community to convey potential impact and a sense of camaraderie.



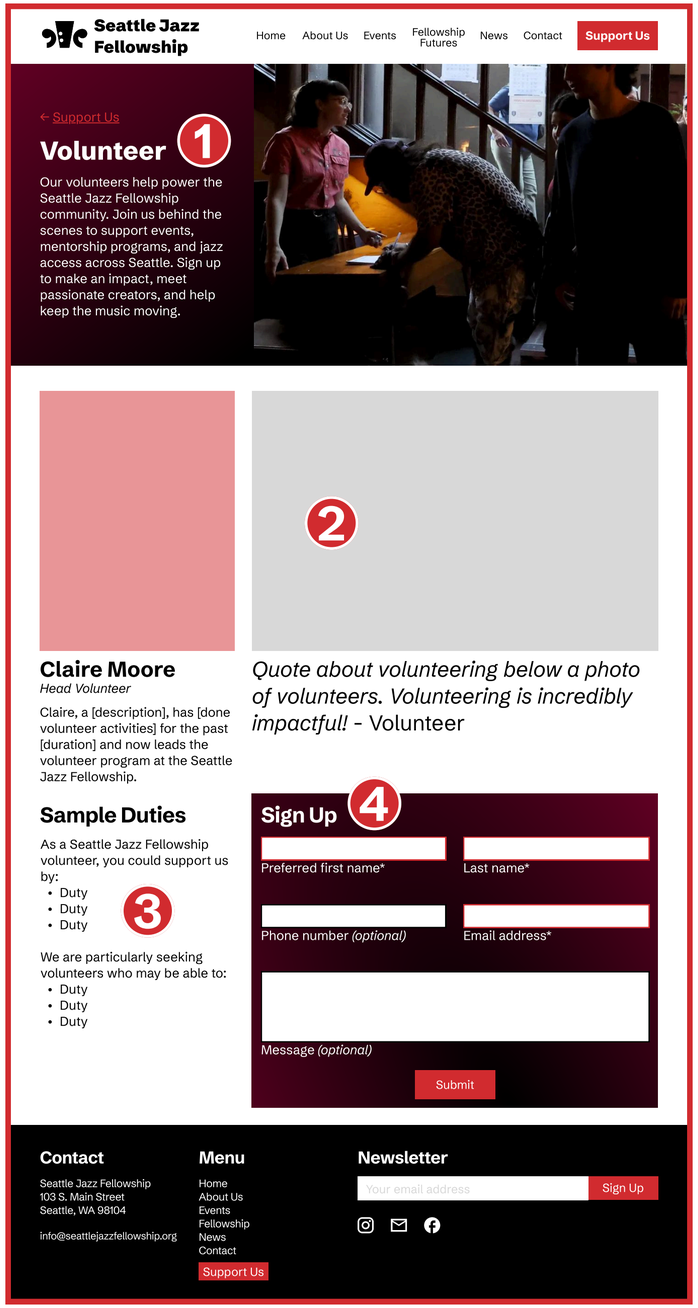
Digital Redesign: Website

Volunteer (after)

From top to bottom, the redesigned volunteer page shows visitors:

1. Information about volunteering at the Seattle Jazz Fellowship.
2. Bios and quotes from volunteers.
3. Sample duties for volunteers.
4. A signup form widget.

Including more information about what volunteering involves gives visitors a clearer sense of the commitment and helps them understand what they're signing up for.



Bios and quotes from current volunteers highlight the community behind the work, adding warmth and a human element that may encourage others to join.

Adding a signup form directly on the page lowers the barrier to getting involved by making the process feel quick and straightforward. Using a warm red for the form's region helps it stand out visually and draws visitors' attention to the next step.

Appendix

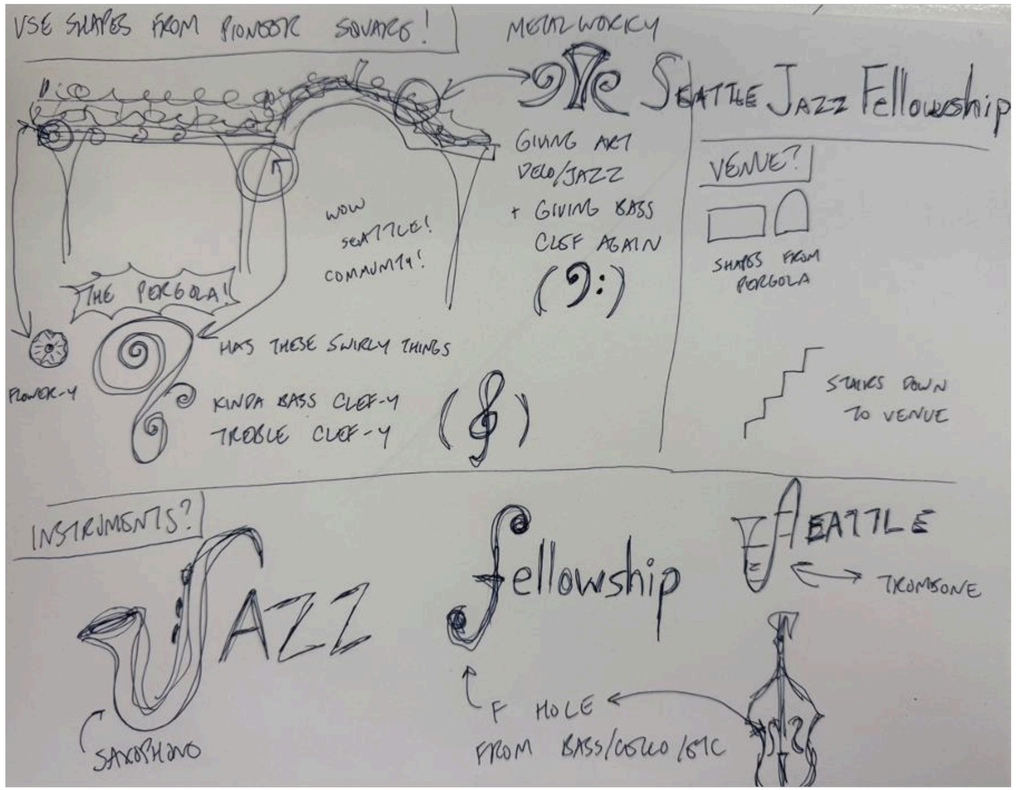
AI usage

I used Amazon Q CLI and ChatGPT to transform some notes and ideas into cohesive, formal writing. I reviewed and edited this content to ensure clarity and accuracy. All ideas and insights are my own.

> **Sample prompt**: “help with this phrasing: The restructured homepage reduces informational redundancy by eliminating overlap between topics on the page.”
> **Response**: “The restructured homepage reduces informational redundancy by removing overlap between topics.”

I used ChatGPT to superimpose my sandwich board design on a sandwich board. The design is my own.

Logo sketches and iterations





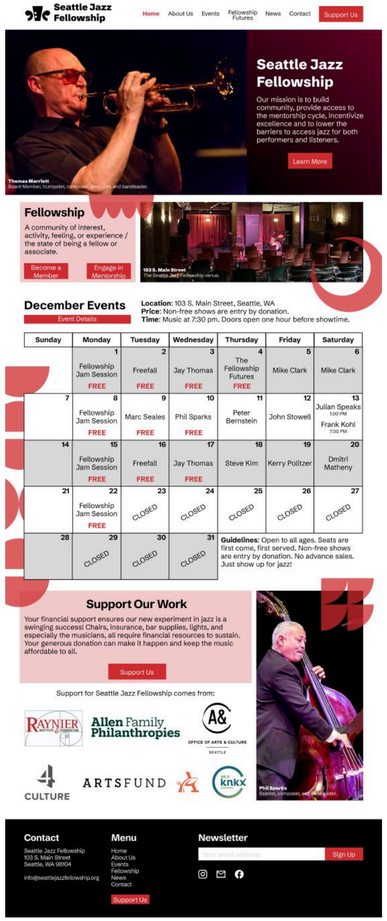
Appendix

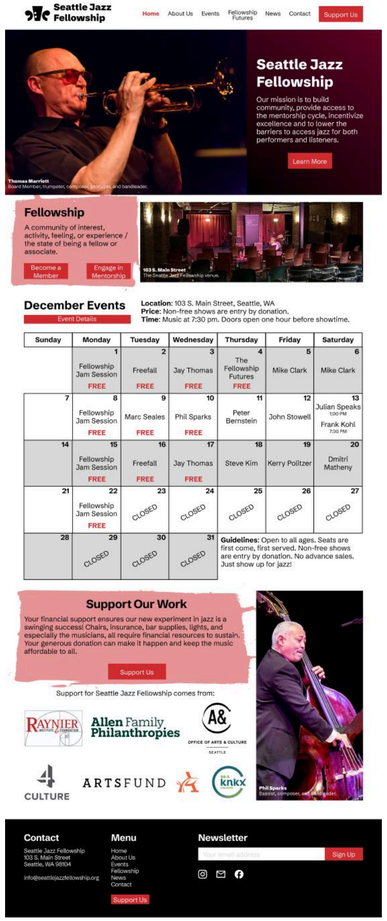
Sandwich board iterations



Website iterations

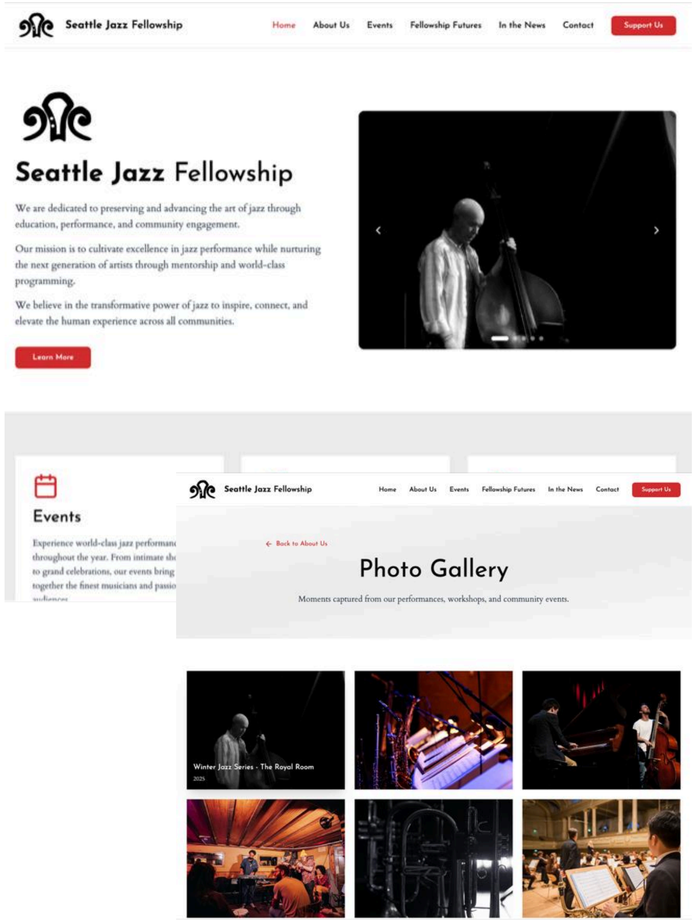


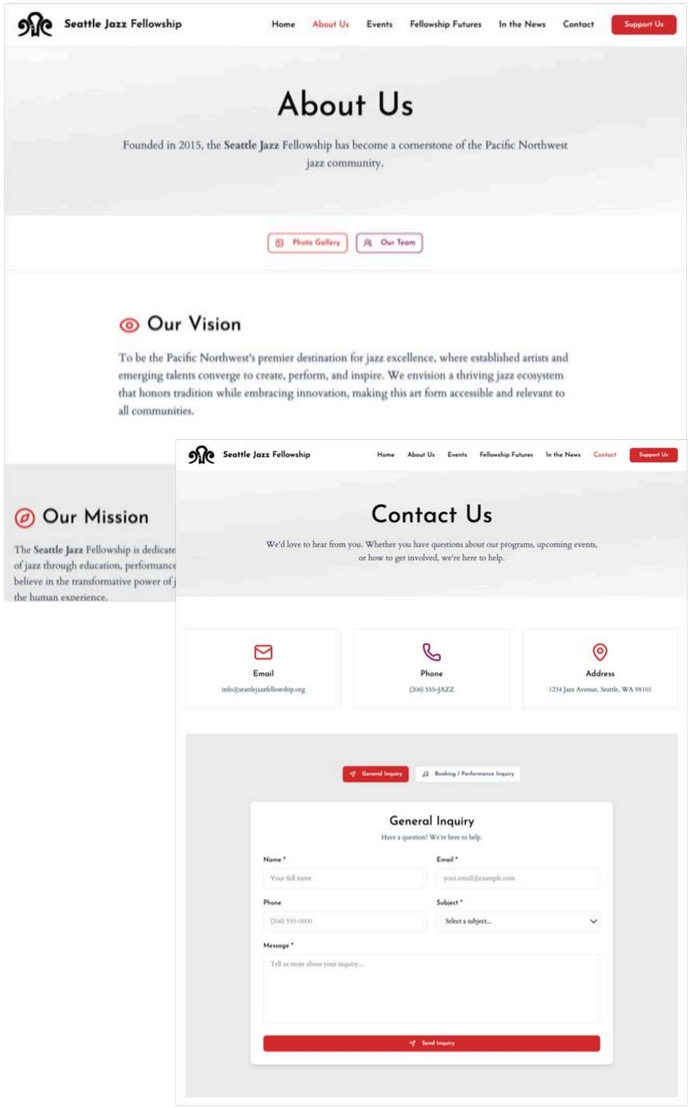


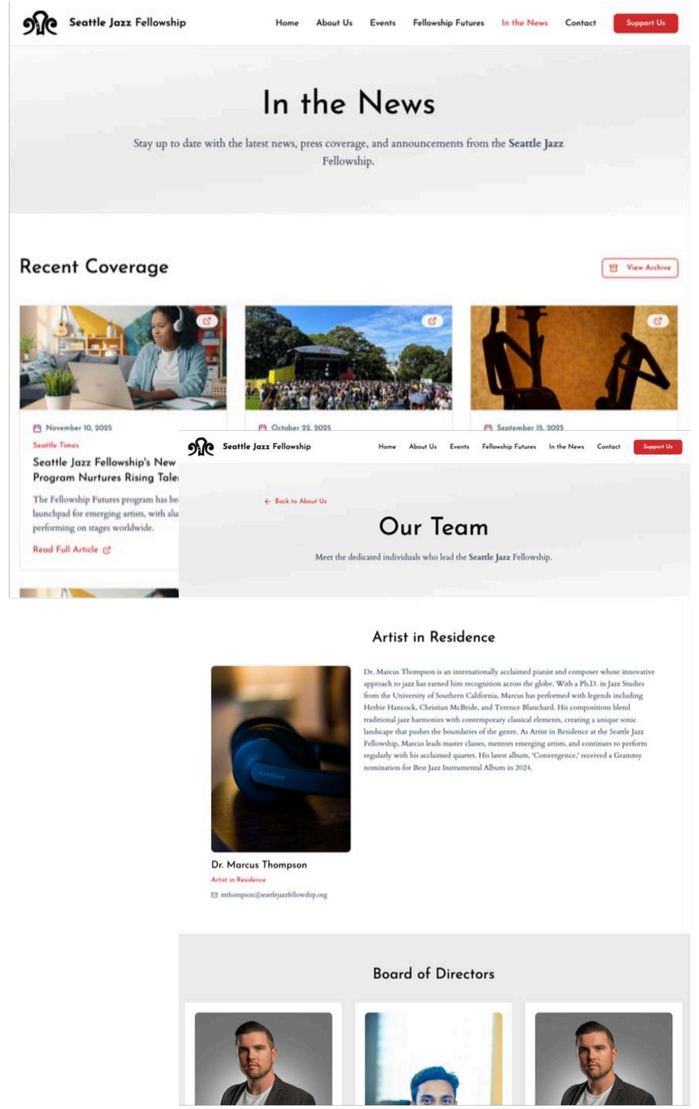


Appendix

Figma Make mockup (AI)

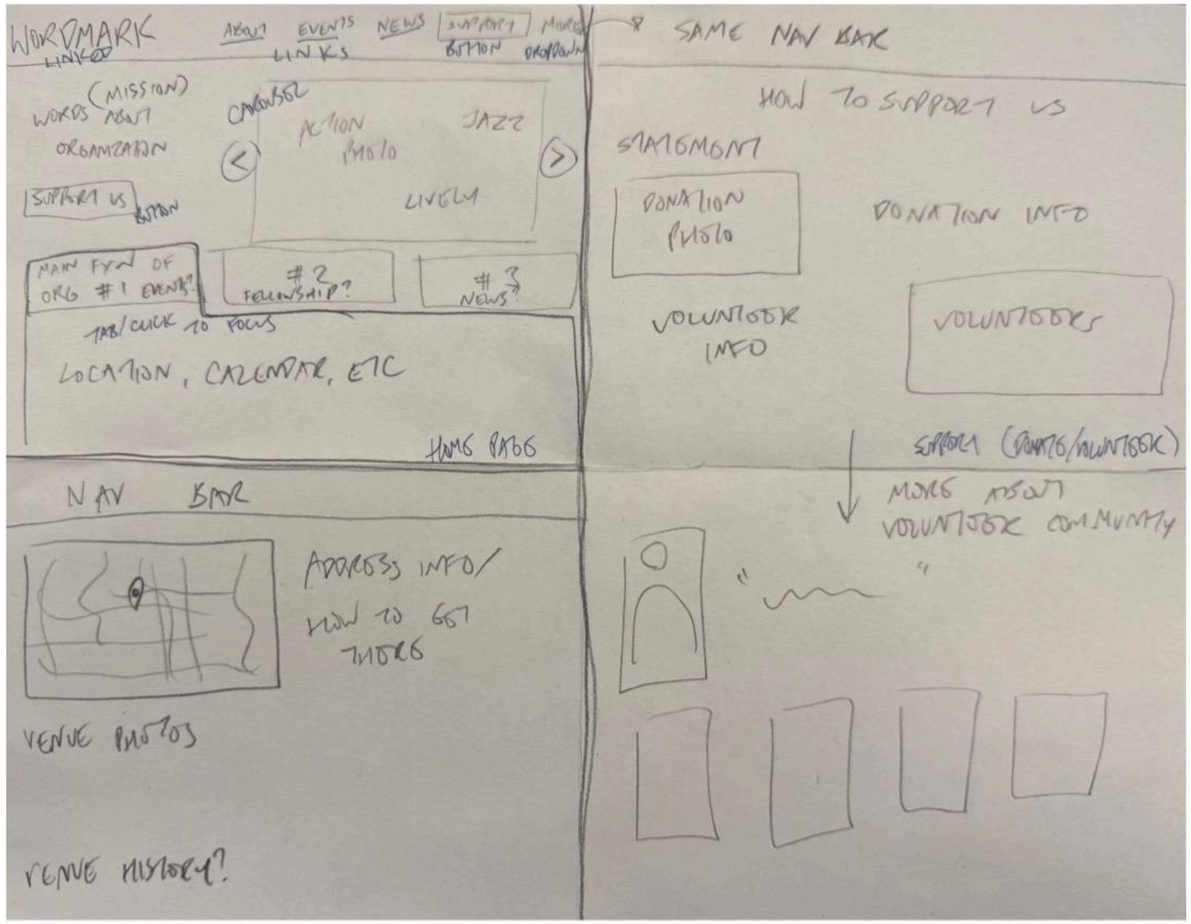


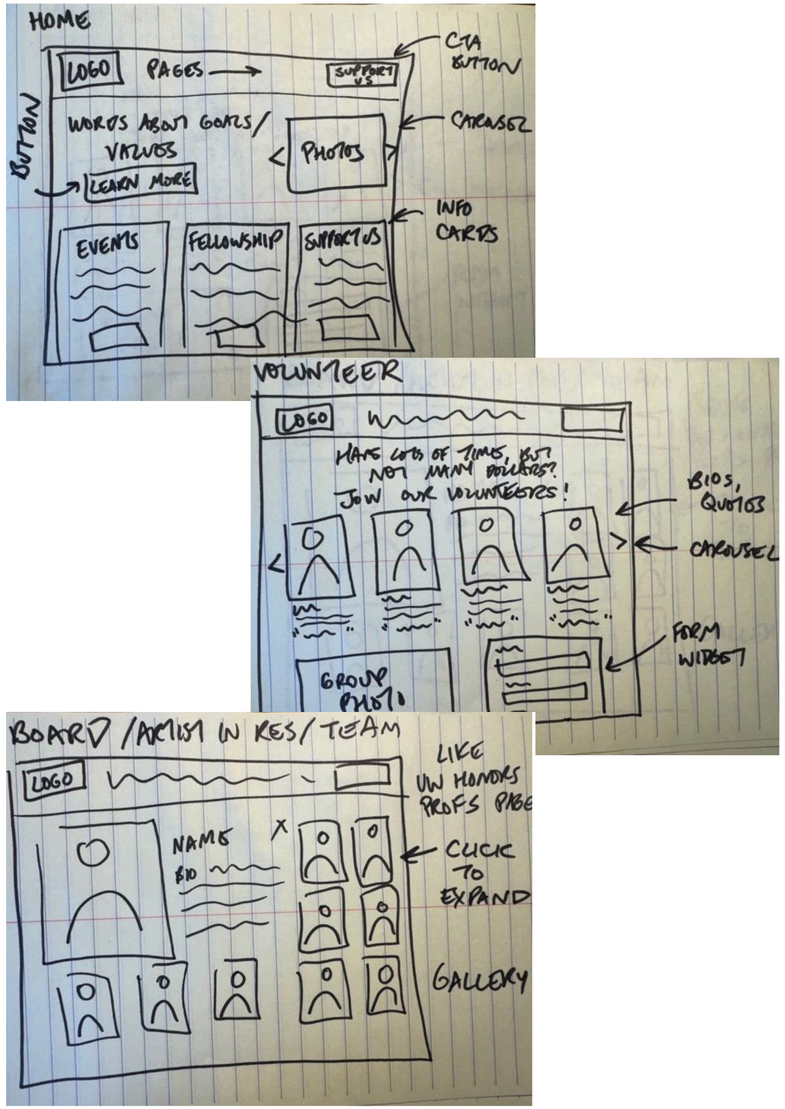




Appendix

Website wireframe sketches





Appendix

Image sources

Organization research:

- **Seattle Jazz Fellowship**: https://seattlejazzfellowship.org/
- **Seattle Symphony**: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/File:Seattle_Symphony_logo.jpg
- **Seattle Music Teachers Association**: https://www.seattlemta.org/
- **Seattle Music Partners**: https://volunteer.uwkc.org/agency/detail/?agency_id=58688

Event photography:

- **Venue imagery**: https://hardlyraining.com/2024/01/27/photos-seattle-jazz-fellowship-opening-weekend/, https://seattlejazzscene.com/category/seattle-jazz/seattle-jazz-fellowship-seattle-jazz/
- **Hero image of Thomas Marriott**: https://www.allaboutjazz.com/20-seattle-jazz-musicians-you-should-know-thomas-marriott-thomas-marriott
- **Phil Sparks image**: https://nathanbreedlove.com/artist/phil-sparks/
- **Volunteer image**: https://www.seattletimes.com/entertainment/music/seattle-jazz-fellowships-monday-night-jazz-jam-draws-all-ages-crowd

Logo research and design inputs:

- **Pioneer Square pergola**: https://pioneersquare.org/
- **Bass clef**: https://hellomusictheory.com/learn/bass-clef/

Logo research and design inputs (cont.):

- **Guitar headstock**: https://kennedyviolins.com/products/guitar-machine-head-tuning-set-with-strap-buttons-in-four-colors
- **F-hole**: https://www.thestrad.com/tracing-the-development-of-violin-f-hole-design-through-peeling-an-orange/5652.article

Design inspiration and alignment:

- https://www.pinterest.com/pin/4081455907110080/
- https://www.pinterest.com/pin/21744010695689868/
- https://www.pinterest.com/pin/8655424281963522/
- https://www.pinterest.com/pin/81979655712108749/
- https://www.pinterest.com/pin/1477812374127650/